

White paper

***Idea: An AI planner that plans for you, but also encourages you to reflect on goal planning.***

## ***Core Idea:***

AI systems are currently seen as tools that enhance your productivity by planning on your behalf, reducing the time taken to plan and making more time for you to execute. While this is a huge benefit in this fast moving world, AI is looking at your goal planning as an optimization problem, but your desired outcomes are not for an optimized life, they are for a fulfilling and meaningful life.

This is why we introduce “Compass”, an AI planning assistant that encourages user reflection during the planning stage for a desired goal.

## ***Design Approach:***

Most AI assistants in the market have a “means paternalistic”<sup>1</sup> approach, where the user inputs their desired goals, and the AI plans every step for the user. Though this leads to a significant reduction in cognitive load, it might also lead to a detachment from goals, because there is no genuine engagement with the processing of achieving the goal.

Therefore, Compass uses a “maternalistic”<sup>2</sup> approach. In this approach the user gives their desired goal to the system and the system gives them suggestions as to how they can achieve this goal. It is not making a decision for them, it is showing them the possible paths forward.

For example, a user wants to prioritize their health despite their busy schedule. Compass will give them ideas like: run with a friend, cycle to work or maybe show them that they have time for a quick workout on the weekend. Compass is giving the user the freedom to choose one of these options or come up with a new idea that aligns with their values and lifestyle. Our approach is to build an AI that helps humans live more thoughtful, meaningful, and self-directed lives, where these systems help humans see all the possibilities available to them.

## ***Business development and financing approach:***

### **Phase I: Development**

During this phase the project will be self funded, through bootstrapping. This is to ensure that the core vision of the app remains intact without any interference of stakeholders. This phase will focus on building a functional prototype, rigorous testing and refining according to feedback

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<sup>1</sup> This design approach was mentioned in the paper Digital Wellness and Persuasive Technologies, by Laura Specker Sullivan and Peter Reiner (In Philosophy & Technology)

<sup>2</sup> This design approach is motivated by the paper Digital Wellness and Persuasive Technologies, by Laura Specker Sullivan and Peter Reiner (In Philosophy & Technology)

from beta testers.

## **Phase II: Deployment**

After the project is deployed, a market survey will be done to see how many users are interacting with the app, and a tiered subscription scheme will be put in place accordingly. Revenue generated during this phase will be reinvested for product development and scaling.

## **Phase III: Investor search**

This phase will mark the beginning of finding investors that have the same values in mind for the future development of AI. Rather than pursuing capital from investors who prioritise quick monetisation above all else, Compass will seek partners who genuinely believe in human-centred technology and the responsible development of AI systems. Potential investors will be evaluated not only on the financial support they can provide, but also on their willingness to preserve the core vision of the product.

# ChatGPTs analysis

# ChatGPT Analysis:

## **Prompt Given:**

Analyze this white paper in about 500 words with the following points:

1. Strengths
2. Weaknesses
3. Potential to be converted into reality
4. Monetary gain for sustaining the company

## *Analysis of the Compass White Paper*

### **Strengths**

The strongest aspect of Compass is its clear differentiation from existing AI productivity tools. Most planning assistants focus on efficiency and optimization, whereas Compass emphasizes reflection, autonomy, and personal meaning. This human-centered philosophy addresses a growing concern that AI systems may reduce user agency by making too many decisions on behalf of individuals.

Another strength is the "maternalistic" design approach. Instead of prescribing a single path, Compass presents multiple options and encourages users to make their own choices. This aligns well with psychological research suggesting that people are more committed to goals when they actively participate in the planning process. By balancing guidance with freedom, Compass has the potential to foster deeper engagement and long-term behavioral change.

The business development strategy is also thoughtfully structured. Beginning with bootstrapping allows the founders to preserve the original vision and avoid early investor pressure. The phased approach—development, deployment, and then investor search—demonstrates strategic patience and a commitment to validating the product before scaling.

### **Weaknesses**

While the philosophical vision is compelling, the white paper lacks detail on the technical implementation. It does not explain how Compass will generate reflective suggestions, measure user values, or distinguish itself from existing AI systems such as ChatGPT, Notion AI, or productivity coaching applications. Without a clear technological advantage, the product risks being perceived as a feature rather than a standalone platform.

The concept of a "maternalistic" AI is also somewhat vague. While the intention is to encourage reflection, users may still expect actionable plans. If the system provides only suggestions without sufficient structure, some users may find it less useful than more directive alternatives. The challenge will be finding the right balance between guidance and autonomy.

Additionally, the investor strategy may be difficult to execute. Restricting investment opportunities to value-aligned investors preserves the mission but could limit access to capital and slow growth compared to competitors.

### **Potential to be Converted into Reality**

The concept is highly feasible from a technological standpoint. Current large language models are already capable of generating reflective questions, suggesting multiple pathways to goals, and adapting recommendations based on user preferences. A minimum viable product could be built using existing AI APIs combined with scheduling, journaling, and habit-tracking features.

The larger challenge is not technical feasibility but product-market fit. Users often seek planning tools to reduce cognitive effort, whereas Compass intentionally reintroduces some level of reflection and engagement. The success of the product will depend on demonstrating that thoughtful planning leads to better outcomes than fully automated planning.

A realistic path would be to target specific niches first, such as personal development, wellness, career planning, or education, before expanding into broader life-planning applications.

### **Monetary Gain and Long-Term Sustainability**

The proposed subscription model is a reasonable starting point. Potential revenue streams could include:

#### **1. Freemium Subscription Model**

- Free tier with basic planning assistance.
- Premium tier with advanced reflection exercises, personalized coaching, and long-term goal tracking.

#### **2. Corporate Wellness Programs**

- Organizations could offer Compass as an employee well-being and productivity tool.

#### **3. Educational Partnerships**

- Universities and schools may use Compass to support student goal-setting and self-directed learning.

#### **4. Professional Coaching Integration**

- Life coaches, career coaches, and therapists could use Compass as a supplementary tool for clients.

The concept has moderate-to-high commercial potential because mental wellness, self-improvement, and AI-assisted coaching are rapidly growing markets. However, sustainable profitability will depend on proving that Compass creates measurable value beyond existing AI assistants. If it successfully positions itself as an "AI for meaningful decision-making" rather than another productivity tool, it could occupy a unique and defensible market niche.

**Overall Assessment:** The white paper presents a compelling vision with strong philosophical foundations and a clear social purpose. Its primary weaknesses are the lack of technical

differentiation and business detail. With a clearer implementation strategy and a well-defined target market, Compass has realistic potential to become a viable and sustainable AI product.

# Critical reflection for GPT's analysis



## **Personal critical reflection on GPT's response**

GPT highlights that the idea is fresh, as it is different from what is existing in the market which in my opinion is a positive point for "compass AI". GPT highlights that the change in design approach is what makes the idea stand out, validating my approach for a new design mentality. Though, it also highlights that the white paper has more of a philosophical vision rather than a technical vision, which I can accept. If we want to propose a technical product, inclusion of technical aspects is also necessary. My opinion was that I had to give a conceptual idea about how the product might work, but turns out the workflow should have been added in a detailed manner. It is also highlighted that the difference in Compass and other AI assistants is only in the core design philosophy, and the proposed idea has no clear technological advantage. Additionally, the strategy for investment is highlighted as difficult to execute, as restricting opportunities to value-aligned investors might preserve mission but will lead to slow growth compared to competitors. Though I would like to add that, personally slow growth would be better than giving up on the values that the product was made on.

GPT does agree that this is a feasible idea from a "technological standpoint". Since a minimum viable product can be built using existing AI APIs combined with idea-specific features.

The real challenge is not development but product-market fit, as the introduction of "reflection and engagement" might be seen as an increase in cognitive effort, which the users are looking to reduce. But looking at the current sentiment around AI "taking control of human autonomy", I think that users might appreciate that the AI is acting as a subordinate and not authority.

For market-fit GPT suggests targeting specific niches first which I agree with. Instead of focusing on a general AI assistant we can change the approach to use-case specific AI. This might help in better user experience.

In the aspect of monetary gain, the proposed model is seen as a reasonable starting point. GPT suggests more revenue streams which do seem appropriate and aligned with the intended use of the product. The best seemed university students as the idea stemmed from me being a uni student who wants to optimize my life in a meaningful way. Also GPTs suggestion regarding therapists using the product as a supplementary tool seemed like a genuinely good idea, as this might help people heal and move forward.

After analysing the white paper according to GPT's response, it can be seen that even though the idea is strong it still needs more refining and fine tuning in the technical aspects and investment aspect to be developed into a potential AI product. Through this analysis I hope to take this idea from "just an idea I had" to a product developed with genuine care for its users.